

YUEYAO ZHANG

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Knoxville, TN

EDUCATION

University of Tennessee, Knoxville

Ph.D. in Learning, Design, and Technology

Advisor: Dr. Yukyeong Song

Knoxville, TN

Starting Aug 2026

University of Michigan

M.A. in Educational Studies

Concentration: Designing for Innovation: Learning, Instruction, and Technologies

Ann Arbor, MI

Aug 2024 – May 2026

GPA: 4.00/4.00

Macao Polytechnic University

B.A. in International Chinese Language Education

GPA: 3.92/4.00

Macao, China

Sep 2020 – Jul 2024

RESEARCH INTERESTS

AI for Education, STEM Education, Online Learning, Community-based and Informal learning, and Learning Sciences

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

FamJam and Green Energy Technologies in the City

Supervisor: Dr. Angela Calabrese Barton, University of Tennessee, Knoxville

Sep 2025 – Apr 2026

- Analyzed interview and map-based data through thematic coding in Dedoose and authored analytical memos and report sections on how transnational youth make sense of climate change and community impacts.
- Co-designed digital and hands-on STEM materials with teachers, families, and youth to support accessible, engaging after-school environmental learning.
- Mentored middle-school STEM classrooms in Michigan while collecting observation and interview data for research on climate-justice education.

NOAA B-WET Sustainability Teacher Fellowship (STF) Evaluation Project

Supervisor: Dr. Victoria J. Milazzo Bigelow

Oct 2025 – Dec 2025

- Conducted constant comparative analysis of 100 de-identified open-ended survey responses from K–12 educators in Dedoose to identify themes and patterns aligned with program goals and educator experiences.
- Produced coding summaries and structured evaluation memos that synthesized emerging educator patterns and supported reporting for program improvement and funder accountability.

The Role of Short-Form Video in the Acquisition of Chinese as a Foreign Language

Independent Study · Supervisor: Dr. Yifang Ai

Feb 2024 – Apr 2024

- Conducted a literature review on short-form media in second language acquisition, identified a lack of empirical research, and designed an original study to address this gap.
- Designed and administered a 25-item structured questionnaire investigating relationships among video-viewing habits, learner engagement, and attitudes.

- Collected and analyzed 74 valid responses using quantitative cross-variable analysis, indicating a strong positive correlation between learner motivation and short-video viewing habits.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Jinshizhang Elementary School

Volunteer Teacher

Jining, China

Apr 2023 – Jun 2023

- Designed and implemented 10+ English lesson plans for 5th-grade students, integrating interactive activities to foster authentic language use and communication.
- Taught grammar and speaking lessons and produced instructional videos on pronunciation, with 30%+ of students improving their English test performance.
- Developed and adapted curriculum materials grounded in learner-centered and communicative language teaching principles to promote engagement and real-world application.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Center for Academic Innovation, University of Michigan

Course Operation Fellow

Ann Arbor, MI

Mar 2025 – Apr 2026

- Developed an evaluation rubric and conducted beta testing for 25+ online courses offered through Michigan Online, synthesizing findings into faculty reports to improve pedagogical flow, usability, and accessibility.
- Edited and restructured course modules, assessments, captions, visual elements, and discussion prompts across LMS platforms such as Canvas to enhance instructional clarity and learner experience.
- Applied thematic coding and behavioral analytics to 100+ learner interactions to identify low-engagement patterns and propose redesign strategies, including a Reddit-based peer reflection model.

Weiser Center for the Learning Sciences, University of Michigan

Co-Coordinator, Spark Festival of Learning

Ann Arbor, MI

Jan 2025 – Apr 2025

- Co-designed and facilitated a learning festival grounded in learning sciences, translating pedagogical goals into 19 interactive demonstrations and workshops.
- Designed a cross-disciplinary activity book of experiential, hands-on tasks for self-directed learning, promoting inclusive, learner-centered engagement across age groups.
- Applied on-site observation methods to assess engagement using indicators such as time spent, affective expressions, and attendee–facilitator interactions.

SERVICE & OUTREACH

Impression 5 Science Center

Volunteer, Think Tank Youth Action Council (YAC)

Lansing, MI

Sep 2025 – Dec 2025

- Participated in project-based STEM making activities with 5th–12th grade youth in a museum maker space, developing youth-informed ideas and prototypes for hands-on workshops.
- Collaborated with museum staff and educators to translate project outcomes and participant feedback into refinements of youth-centered STEM education programming.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Toothopia: Educational Application Design

- Proposed a research-informed educational game model for oral-health habit development, integrating literature review, needs analysis, and user personas.
- Prototyped four core mini-games in Figma with progress tracking, avatar customization, and daily reflection prompts, applying positive-reinforcement principles and immersive storytelling.
- Produced a report and demo analyzing formative playtesting, usability, and market feasibility, receiving positive supervisor feedback.

HONORS & AWARDS

- 2026–2027 Carolyn R. Hodges Graduate Fellowship (\$15,000), University of Tennessee, Knoxville
- 2025 Rackham International Students Fellowship (\$14,596), University of Michigan
- 2024 Marsal Family School of Education Incoming Student Scholarship, University of Michigan
- 2021 Stanley Ho Foundation Scholarship, Macao Polytechnic University

SKILLS

- **Data Analysis & Programming:** Python, R, SQL
- **Instructional Design:** Articulate Storyline, H5P, Figma, Canva
- **Media Production:** Adobe Photoshop, Premiere Pro, InDesign, XD
- **Languages:** Mandarin Chinese (native), English (professional)